

Alex Chow

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📄 AlexChow 📧 alxcwj

Education

Stanford University

2020 — Present

Ph.D. Candidate in Sociology

- Dissertation: "The Social Significance of Education"
- Dissertation Committee: Dr. Michelle Jackson (Advisor), Dr. Florencia Torche, Dr. David Grusky
- Qualifying Exams: Social Stratification, Economic Sociology

Stanford University

2020 — 2022

Master of Arts in Sociology

- Master's Thesis: "Expansion and Returns: A Causal Inference Approach to the Positional Value of Education"
- Advisors: Dr. Michelle Jackson, Dr. Florencia Torche

University of British Columbia

2016 — 2020

Bachelor of Arts (Honours) in Sociology

- Honors Thesis: "Complicating the International Student Classification in Canada: A Computational Grounded Theory Approach"
- Supervisor: Dr. Qiang Fu

Research Interests

Social stratification, Educational inequality, Social mobility, Status, Higher education, Quantitative and statistical analysis, Survey design, Computational methods: Network analysis, Natural language processing, Large language models

Peer-reviewed Publications

Chow, Alex, and Neil Guppy. 2021. "Intergenerational Educational Mobility Over the Past Century in Canada." *Canadian Review of Sociology* 58(3):372-398.

Works-in-progress

Chow, Alex. "The Subjective Social Ladder: Actual, Perceived, and Projected Mobility in 22 Countries." Under review.

Chow, Alex. "How Much Does Education Matter for Social Status? Findings from a Conjoint Experiment." In preparation.

Qiao, Si, Junxi Qu, Rosina Pradhananga, Alex Chow, Sarah-Eve Dill, David Grusky, and Anthony Gar-On Yeh. "Residential Relocation Reshapes Daily Exposure Segregation." Under review.

van der Velden, Max, David Grusky, and Alex Chow. "A Supervised LLM System for Large-Scale, Data-Secure Qualitative Coding." In preparation.

Other Publications

Taylor, Alison, Stephanie Glick, Nasim Peikazadi, Alex Chow, and Beverly Allan. 2018. "Creating Reciprocal and Ethical Learning Partnerships in the Downtown Eastside: Messages from participants on the development of partnership planning tools."

Fellowships

Knight-Hennessy Scholars Program

2020

Stanford University

Data Science for Social Good (DSSG) Fellowship

2019

*Data Science Institute, UBC***Research Grants**

Graduate Research Opportunity

2025

*Stanford School of Humanities and Sciences***Sociology PhD Dissertation Research Opportunity**

2025

*Stanford Department of Sociology***Honors & Awards**

Governor General's Silver Medal in Arts

2020

*University of British Columbia***Outstanding Graduating Student, Canadian Sociological Association**

2020

*Canadian Sociological Association***Kaspar Naegele Memorial Prize in Sociology**

2020

*University of British Columbia***University of British Columbia Scholarship**

2019

*University of British Columbia***Faculty of Arts International Student Scholarship**

2019

*University of British Columbia***Katherine Brearley Arts Scholarship**

2019

*University of British Columbia***Faculty of Arts International Student Scholarship**

2018

*University of British Columbia***Katherine Brearley Arts Scholarship**

2018

*University of British Columbia***Mo Lin Yu Memorial Prize in the Faculty of Arts**

2018

*University of British Columbia***Conference Presentations**

How Much Does Education Matter for Social Status? Findings from a Conjoint Experiment

Jan 2026

*RC28 Online Meeting on Educational Inequalities | Sciences Po (Virtual)***Perceptions of Social Status: Findings from a Conjoint Experiment**

Aug 2025

*American Sociological Association Annual Meeting 2025 | Chicago, IL***Perceptions of Social Status: Findings from a Conjoint Experiment**

Nov 2023

*New Methods to Measure Intergenerational Mobility | Stone Center for Research on Wealth Inequality and Mobility, University of Chicago, IL***The Subjective Social Ladder: Actual, Perceived, and Projected Mobility in 22 Countries**

Aug 2023

*American Sociological Association Annual Meeting 2023 | Philadelphia, PA***The Post-Liberal Social Classes: Actual and Perceived Levels of Income Inequality and Associated Values**

Jun 2023

*International Sociological Association World Congress of Sociology 2023 | Melbourne, Australia***Expansion and Returns: A Causal Inference Approach to the Positional Value of Education**

Aug 2022

American Sociological Association Annual Meeting 2022 | Los Angeles, CA

Intergenerational Educational Assortative Mating: A Study of Individuals Born Aug 2021 Between 1970 and 1985

American Sociological Association Annual Meeting 2021 | Virtual

Intergenerational Educational Assortative Mating: A Study of Individuals Born May 2021 Between 1970 and 1985

Canadian Population Society Annual Meeting 2021 | Virtual

Intergenerational Educational Mobility Over the Past Century in Canada *Aug 2019*

American Sociological Association Annual Meeting 2019 (Honors Program) | New York, NY

Intergenerational Educational Mobility Over the Past Century in Canada *Jun 2019*

Canadian Sociological Association Annual Meeting 2019 | Vancouver, BC

Intergenerational Educational Mobility Over the Past Century in Canada *May 2019*

UBC Anthropology and Sociology Undergraduate Conference 2019 | Vancouver, BC

Intergenerational Educational Mobility Over the Past Century in Canada *Mar 2019*

UBC Multidisciplinary Undergraduate Research Conference 2019 | Vancouver, BC

Intergenerational Educational Mobility Over the Past Century in Canada *Jan 2019*

Harvard University National Collegiate Research Conference 2019 | Cambridge, MA

Research Experience

Graduate Researcher *2020 — Present*

Stanford University

Research roles in sociology and poverty/inequality labs.

- Voices Lab: "American Voices Project." Research Assistant for Dr. David Grusky, Stanford Center on Poverty and Inequality. (Jun 2025 – Present)
- Social Networks Lab: "Social Networks and Cellphone Mobility Data." Lab Coordinator and Research Assistant for Dr. David Grusky, Stanford Center on Poverty and Inequality. (Mar 2023 – Present)
- "COVID and Infant Health." Research Assistant for Dr. Florencia Torche, Stanford Department of Sociology. (Sep 2022 – May 2023)

Undergraduate Research Assistant *2016 — 2020*

University of British Columbia

Research experience in sociology and data science labs.

- "Intergenerational Educational Mobility Over the Past Century in Canada." Co-Investigator with Dr. Neil Guppy, UBC Department of Sociology. (May 2018 – May 2021)
- "Developing Natural Language Processing Tools for Sharing of Indigenous and Community Knowledge." Data Science for Social Good Research Fellow, National Energy Board & UBC Data Science Institute. (May 2019 – Dec 2019)
- "Romantic Relationships in Canada." Research Assistant for Dr. Yue Qian, UBC Department of Sociology. (May 2019 – Dec 2019)

Teaching & Mentorship

Graduate Teaching, Mentorship, and Supervision *2020 — 2025*

Stanford University

- Graduate Research Assistant Internship Supervisor, Stanford Institute for Research in the Social Sciences Research Experience Program. (Nov 2024 – Aug 2025)
- Graduate Research Mentor, Stanford Summer Research Early Identification Program. (Jun 2021 – Aug 2021)
- Graduate Teaching Assistant, SOC 382: Sociological Methodology II (Statistics for an Open Science: Principles of Regression II). (Jan 2023 – Mar 2023)
- Graduate Teaching Assistant, SOC 381: Sociological Methodology I (Introduction). (Sep 2022 – Dec 2022)
- Graduate Teaching Assistant, SOC 114/214: Economic Sociology. (Sep 2021 – Dec 2021)

Undergraduate Teaching and Mentorship

2016 — 2020

University of British Columbia

- Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, ANTH/SOCI 480: Urban Ethnographic Field School. (May 2020 – Jun 2020)
- Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, SOCI 372: Contemporary Directions in Theory. (Jan 2020 – Apr 2020)
- Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, DSCI 100: Introduction to Data Science. (Sep 2019 – Apr 2020)
- Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, SOCI 301: Development and Underdevelopment. (Sep 2019 – Dec 2019)
- Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, SOCI 100: Introduction to Sociology. (Sep 2018 – May 2019)
- Student Directed Seminar Leader and Coordinator, SOCI 433: Scaling the Ivory Tower: Sociology of Higher Education. (Sep 2019 – Apr 2020)
- Workshop Leader and Coordinator, Undergraduate Social Statistics Study Group. (Oct 2019)
- Mentorship Program Coordinator and Peer Mentor, Coordinated Arts Program. (Sep 2017 – Apr 2019)

Academic Service

Journal Reviewer

2023 — Present

- American Journal of Sociology
- Canadian Review of Sociology
- International Journal of Lifelong Education
- Health Literacy Research and Practice

Undergraduate Academic Service

2016 — 2020

University of British Columbia

- Advisory Committee Member, Advanced Research Cohort (ARC) Program, UBC Department of Sociology. (Jan 2019 – May 2020)
- Tenure-Track Instructor Hiring Committee Member, Coordinated Arts Program, UBC Faculty of Arts. (Jan 2019 – May 2019)
- Lead Typesetter and Associate Editor, Sojourners: Undergraduate Journal of Sociology. (Sep 2017 – May 2019)
- Selection Panel Member, Arts Undergraduate Society Humanities and Social Sciences Conference. (Feb 2018)

Skills

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- Technical: Python, R, Stata
 - Languages: English, Mandarin

Professional Affiliations

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- American Sociological Association
 - Canadian Sociological Association
 - Canadian Population Society
 - International Sociological Association

References

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- Dr. Michelle Jackson (PhD Advisor): mvjsoc@stanford.edu
 - Dr. David Grusky (Dissertation Committee Member): grusky@stanford.edu
 - Dr. Jeremy Freese (Dissertation Committee Member): jfreese@stanford.edu
 - Dr. Florencia Torche (Dissertation Committee Member): ftorche@princeton.edu